ABOUT THIS PIECE

Highway

Katherine Conklin

WHAT IT IS

A script sample for a road-trip comedy, shown scene by scene.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Dialogue, pacing, and how the story escalates.

The work itself starts on the next page.

Highway

A stoner comedy · Script sample · Katherine Conklin

Opening scene: the road trip

EXT. CALIFORNIA HIGHWAY - DAY

Ben and Zack are driving through the sunny California desert, music blasting, smoke filling the car. They are clearly having the time of their lives.

BEN (laughing, exhaling smoke)
"I told you, man, nothing beats a road trip."

ZACK (grinning, taking a hit)
"Especially when there's zero traffic and a whole lotta weed."

They are completely carefree as they make their way toward Utah.

Middle act: the arrest

EXT. UTAH HIGHWAY - LATER

The mood shifts when they see flashing red and blue lights in their rearview mirror.

BEN (panicking)
"Oh crap, dude. We're not in California anymore."

ZACK (nervous)
"Just stay cool. Maybe he won't notice."

Officer Rick, a stern and no-nonsense type, approaches the car. The tension builds as he questions them and eventually discovers the stash of weed.

OFFICER RICK (sternly)
"Mind stepping out of the car, gentlemen?"

Ben and Zack are arrested and taken to jail.

The edibles incident

INT. JAIL CELL - NIGHT

While processing Ben and Zack, Officer Rick finds a bag of edibles, thinking it is candy. Without thinking twice, he pops a few in his mouth.

ZACK (whispering to Ben, laughing)
"Dude... did he just eat the edibles?"

BEN (stifling laughter)
"Oh man... this is about to get interesting."

As the edibles kick in, Officer Rick starts acting strangely. Ben and Zack, from their cell, watch in amusement as Rick becomes more relaxed and starts

questioning his job.

Climax: the high officer

INT. JAIL CELL - LATER

Officer Rick, now fully high, stumbles back to the cell with a goofy grin on his face.

OFFICER RICK (laughing)
"You know... maybe this whole weed thing isn't so bad after all."

Ben and Zack share a knowing look, realizing they can convince Rick to let them go.

BEN (smirking)
"So... how about you open that door for us, and we call it even?"

OFFICER RICK (still laughing)
"Yeah... yeah, why not?"

Rick opens the cell, and the friends walk free, laughing all the way.

Final scene: the dispensary

EXT. UTAH - A FEW YEARS LATER

Fast forward to Ben, Zack, and Officer Rick standing in front of a newly opened marijuana dispensary, the first in Utah. They smile as they look back on their unlikely friendship.

OFFICER RICK (laughing)
"Who would've thought that night would lead to this?"

ZACK (grinning)
"Hey, everything happens for a reason, right?"

The film ends with the trio celebrating their success, having turned a wild road trip into a business venture.